

Wealth Strategy Snapshot: Educational Analysis

2026 Tax Year Planning

Prepared for Lisa Roi | February 2026

Educational scenario modeling for discussion with licensed professionals

Executive Summary

This analysis explores tax optimization strategies and investment concepts for the 2026 tax year, tailored to your financial profile. Given your current focus on IRS liability resolution and credit rehabilitation, this snapshot prioritizes foundational strategies that maximize tax efficiency while building toward your goals of retirement rebuilding, real estate investment, and business growth.

Based on your profile as a W-2 employee with emerging self-employment income, age 60 (eligible for SUPER catch-up contributions under SECURE 2.0), and moderately aggressive risk tolerance, this snapshot models potential first-year value ranging from **\$22,486** (conservative scenario) to **\$68,188** (aggressive scenario). Implementation of any strategy should be verified with your CPA and licensed financial advisor.

Modeled 2026 First-Year Value:

Conservative Scenario: **\$22,486** | Aggressive Scenario: **\$68,188**

Section 1: Current Financial Position

PRIMARY INCOME

W-2 Employment: <\$75,000

SELF-EMPLOYMENT INCOME

Side Business: <\$75K gross / <\$25K net

BUSINESS STRUCTURE

Single-Member LLC (Sole Prop) - <6 months

LOCATION

Churchville, NY (High-tax state)

FILING STATUS

Single

AGE

60 (SUPER Catch-Up Eligible)

ESTIMATED MARGINAL RATE

~30% (22-24% Federal + 6-7% NY)

RISK TOLERANCE

Moderately Aggressive (Growth-Focused)

CURRENT CREDIT SCORE

584 (Previous: 780)

HOME EQUITY

Moderate (\$25K-\$100K)

TIME AVAILABLE

5-10 hours/week

INVESTMENT CAPITAL

Conservative: \$7,500 / Aggressive: \$75,000

Critical Context: Currently resolving scam/coercion situation resulting in IRS and state tax liability. Prior credit score was 780. Primary focus: debt reduction, tax liability resolution, and retirement rebuilding. Promotion anticipated that may more than double current income.

Stated Goals

- Launch Wellness App (TM & Publishing stage)
- Start wealth building via real estate
- Develop consulting side hustle (Accounting & Notary)
- Resolve tax situation and rebuild retirement
- Reduce unsecured debt as quickly as possible

Current Assets & Resources

- **Vehicle:** 2019 VW Jetta (mixed use 25-75% business)
- **Home Office:** Dedicated area (not full room)
- **Equipment:** Computer and tech equipment available
- **Professional Services:** Has CPA/Tax professional

- **Retirement:** Has employer retirement plan (looking to optimize)

Wealth Strategy Snapshot | 2026 Tax Year Planning | Educational Analysis Only | Consult Licensed Professionals Before Implementation

Section 2: Timeline Awareness & Implementation Considerations (2026 Planning)

These timeline items are provided for calendar awareness. Verify applicability and timing with your tax professional.

Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
- CPA consultation: IRS liability resolution strategy and payment plan options - Verify 2025 IRA contribution eligibility (deadline April 15) - Review current W-4 withholding with CPA	- Solo 401(k) research: Compare Fidelity, Schwab, Vanguard zero-fee options - Discuss SUPER catch-up eligibility (age 60) with CPA - HDHP evaluation for potential HSA access	- Home office documentation: Measure dedicated space, photograph setup - Vehicle mileage log: Establish tracking system for 2026 - Investment account research: Brokerages for BTC/ETF access	- Augusta Rule research: Comparable rental FMV documentation 2025 IRA contribution decision (April 15 deadline approaching) - Credit rehabilitation strategy discussion with CPA

Key 2026 Deadlines to Note

Deadline	Item	Notes
April 15, 2026	2025 IRA/HSA contributions	Last day for prior-year contributions
December 31, 2026	Solo 401(k) establishment	Required for 2026 employee deferrals
December 31, 2026	401(k) employee contributions	Last day for 2026 deferrals
April 15, 2027	2026 IRA/HSA contributions	Can make 2026 contributions until this date

Section 3: 2025 Tax Year — Remaining Opportunities (Before April 15, 2026)

2025 Strategies Still Available

The following 2025 contributions can still be made until April 15, 2026:

Strategy	2025 Limit	Deadline	Your Opportunity
Traditional/Roth IRA	\$7,000 + \$1,000 (50+) = \$8,000	April 15, 2026	Potential \$8,000 contribution; verify income limits with CPA
HSA Contributions	\$4,300 individual + \$1,000 (55+) = \$5,300	April 15, 2026	Only if had HDHP coverage in 2025
Solo 401(k) Employer Portion	25% of net SE income	Tax filing + extensions	Only if plan existed in 2025 (unlikely given LLC age)
SEP IRA	25% of compensation, up to \$69,000	Tax filing + extensions	Potential option if no Solo 401(k) for 2025

No Longer Available for 2025: 401(k) employee deferrals (December 31 deadline passed), W-4 adjustments (only affect 2026 forward), Augusta Rule rentals (must have occurred in 2025), Solo 401(k) employee contributions (December 31 deadline passed).

Verify 2025 contribution eligibility with your CPA. Making prior-year contributions requires careful coordination with your tax return.

Priority Action: Since your LLC is less than 6 months old, a Solo 401(k) likely didn't exist in 2025. Discuss with your CPA whether a 2025 Traditional or Roth IRA contribution makes sense given your current tax situation.

Section 4: 2026 Tax Optimization Strategies to Explore

The following strategies are presented for educational purposes. Eligibility and implementation must be verified with your CPA. All limits shown are for the 2026 tax year.

Strategy Concept: Solo 401(k) Contributions

Potential Value: \$1,350 - \$2,250 (tax savings) HIGH PRIORITY

What It Is: A retirement plan for self-employed individuals allowing both employee and employer contributions. At age 60, you're eligible for the SECURE 2.0 "super catch-up" of \$11,250 (rather than the standard \$8,000). At a 30% marginal rate, maximum contributions create substantial tax deferrals.

How It Works:

1. Employee deferral: Up to \$24,500 + \$11,250 super catch-up = \$35,750 (limited by SE net income)
2. Employer contribution: 25% of net self-employment income (after 50% SE tax deduction)
3. Your estimated SE net (~\$20K) limits total contributions to approximately \$7,500-\$15,000

Eligibility Criteria: Self-employment income from your LLC, no full-time employees (spouse exception applies), plan must be established by December 31, 2026 for employee contributions.

Verify contribution limits with your CPA. 2026 limits shown. Note: If your W-2 income exceeds \$150,000 in FICA wages, catch-up contributions must be Roth under SECURE 2.0.

Strategy Concept: Backdoor Roth IRA

Potential Value: \$2,580 (tax-advantaged positioning) MEDIUM PRIORITY

What It Is: A two-step process to contribute to a Roth IRA regardless of income limits: contribute to a Traditional IRA, then convert to Roth. At age 60, the 2026 limit is $\$7,500 + \$1,100 \text{ catch-up} = \$8,600$. This positions funds for tax-free growth and qualified withdrawals.

How It Works:

1. Contribute \$8,600 to a Traditional IRA (non-deductible if income limits apply)
2. Convert the Traditional IRA to Roth IRA
3. Pay taxes on any gains between contribution and conversion (minimize by converting quickly)

Eligibility Criteria: Earned income required. No existing Traditional IRA balances simplifies the process (avoids pro-rata rule complications). Discuss timing with CPA given your current tax situation.

The pro-rata rule may affect conversion taxation if you have existing Traditional IRA balances. Verify strategy with your CPA before implementation. 2026 limits shown.

Strategy Concept: Vehicle Expense Deduction (72.5¢/mile for 2026)

Potential Value: \$435 - \$1,088 (tax savings) HIGH PRIORITY

What It Is: Deduction for business use of your 2019 VW Jetta. The 2026 standard mileage rate is 72.5¢ per mile. With 25-75% business use indicated, this creates meaningful deductions for your consulting and notary business travel.

How It Works:

1. Track all business miles with a mileage log (apps like MileIQ simplify this)
2. Calculate: Business miles $\times$ \$0.725 = deduction amount
3. At 30% marginal rate: 5,000 business miles = \$3,625 deduction = \$1,088 tax savings

Eligibility Criteria: Vehicle used for business purposes, contemporaneous mileage log maintained, business purpose documented for each trip.

IRS requires contemporaneous records. Start your mileage log immediately for 2026. Verify deduction method (standard vs. actual) with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: Home Office Deduction

Potential Value: \$150 - \$300 (tax savings) **MEDIUM PRIORITY**

What It Is: Deduction for the portion of your home used regularly and exclusively for business. You indicated a dedicated area (not a full room). The simplified method allows \$5 per square foot up to 300 sq ft (\$1,500 maximum deduction).

How It Works:

1. Measure your dedicated business space in square feet
2. Simplified method: Square feet × \$5 = deduction (max 300 sq ft)
3. At 30% marginal rate: 200 sq ft = \$1,000 deduction = \$300 tax savings

Eligibility Criteria: Space used regularly and exclusively for business, principal place of business or where you meet clients. W-2 employees generally cannot claim this (only applies to self-employment income).

Applies only to your self-employment income, not W-2. Document your space with photos and measurements. Verify eligibility with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: Augusta Rule (Section 280A)

Potential Value: \$1,050 - \$2,520 (tax savings) **MEDIUM PRIORITY**

What It Is: Rent your home to your business for up to 14 days per year at fair market value. The rental income is tax-free to you personally, while the rent is deductible by your business. This transfers money from your business to you personally with tax advantages.

How It Works:

1. Research comparable rental rates for meeting/event spaces in Churchville, NY (\$500-\$700/day typical)
2. Document business purpose (team meetings, client consultations, planning sessions)
3. At 7-12 days: \$3,500-\$8,400 tax-free income; business deduction saves 30% = \$1,050-\$2,520

Eligibility Criteria: Must have legitimate business purpose for rental, fair market value documentation required, maintain rental agreement and meeting minutes.

Document comparable rental rates from venues like hotels or conference spaces. Create rental agreements and document each business use occasion. Verify implementation with your CPA.

Strategy Concept: W-4 Optimization

Potential Value: \$1,200 - \$3,000 (annual cash flow improvement) HIGH PRIORITY

What It Is: Adjusting your W-4 withholding to stop over-withholding from your W-2 paycheck. Many employees receive large refunds—this means they've given the government an interest-free loan. Optimizing your W-4 increases monthly take-home pay.

How It Works:

1. Review your 2024 tax return refund amount with your CPA
2. Calculate appropriate W-4 adjustments using IRS Withholding Estimator
3. Submit updated W-4 to HR; see increased take-home pay within 1-2 pay periods

Eligibility Criteria: W-2 employees with current over-withholding. Particularly valuable given your need for immediate cash flow to address debt and tax liability.

Balance is key—avoid under-withholding penalties. Work with your CPA to calculate the optimal W-4 setting. Review quarterly to adjust as needed.

Strategy Concept: HSA Maximization (If HDHP Available)

Potential Value: \$1,620 (tax savings if eligible) EVALUATE

What It Is: If you transition to a High-Deductible Health Plan (HDHP), you become eligible for a Health Savings Account. At age 60 (55+ catch-up eligible), the 2026 limit for individual coverage is $\$4,400 + \$1,000 = \$5,400$. Triple tax advantage: deductible contributions, tax-free growth, tax-free qualified withdrawals.

How It Works:

1. Evaluate HDHP options during next open enrollment or qualifying life event

- 2. Compare premium savings vs. higher deductible costs
- 3. If HDHP selected: Contribute $\$5,400 \times 30\% = \$1,620$ tax savings + tax-free growth

Eligibility Criteria: Must be enrolled in a qualified HDHP, not covered by other non-HDHP health insurance, not enrolled in Medicare, not claimed as dependent.

You indicated no current HDHP. Evaluate whether HDHP makes sense for your healthcare needs. This strategy becomes available only with HDHP enrollment. 2026 limits shown.

Tax Strategy Summary Table

#	Strategy Concept	Potential Value Range	Priority
1	Solo 401(k) Contributions	\$1,350 - \$2,250	HIGH
2	Backdoor Roth IRA	\$2,580 positioning	MEDIUM
3	Vehicle Expense (72.5¢/mile)	\$435 - \$1,088	HIGH
4	Home Office Deduction	\$150 - \$300	MEDIUM
5	Augusta Rule	\$1,050 - \$2,520	MEDIUM
6	W-4 Optimization	\$1,200 - \$3,000	HIGH
7	HSA Maximization (if eligible)	\$1,620	EVALUATE

Note: Potential values shown are modeled estimates based on your profile and 2026 IRS limits. Actual results depend on your specific circumstances. Verify all strategies with your CPA before implementation.

Section 5: Primary Strategy Education — Building Your Financial Foundation

Phase 1: Stabilization & Foundation (Current Focus)

Given your current situation—recovering from a scam, addressing IRS liability, and rebuilding credit from 584—the immediate priority is stabilization before aggressive wealth-building. This section outlines the educational framework for your primary strategies.

Understanding Your SECURE 2.0 Advantage (Age 60)

The SECURE 2.0 Act of 2022 introduced "super catch-up" contributions for individuals aged 60-63. This is a significant advantage for your retirement rebuilding goals:

Account Type	Standard 2026 Limit	Your Age 60 Limit	Difference
401(k) Employee Deferral	\$24,500	$\$24,500 + \$11,250 = \$35,750$	+\$11,250
IRA/Roth IRA	\$7,500	$\$7,500 + \$1,100 = \$8,600$	+\$1,100
HSA (if eligible)	\$4,400	$\$4,400 + \$1,000 = \$5,400$	+\$1,000

Why This Matters: At age 60, you have a four-year window (ages 60-63) with the highest catch-up limits available. This is designed specifically for individuals like yourself who want to accelerate retirement savings.

Credit Rehabilitation & Real Estate Path

You expressed strong interest in real estate (co-hosting, arbitrage, and ownership). However, with a current credit score of 584, conventional financing is challenging. Here's the educational framework for your real estate journey:

Credit Score Range	Financing Options	Your Strategy Phase
580-619	FHA loans possible (higher rates), hard money, seller financing	Current: Focus on rehabilitation

620-679	Conventional loans available (higher rates), more options	Target: 6-12 months
680-739	Better rates, investment property loans accessible	Target: 12-18 months
740+	Best rates, full menu of financing options	Long-term goal

Lower-Capital Entry Points for Real Estate (Available Now):

- **Co-hosting/Property Management:** Service-based, no credit required, start earning immediately
- **Airbnb Arbitrage:** Lease + furnish model requires landlord approval, not bank financing
- These align with your 5-10 hour/week availability and build experience for future ownership

Consulting Business Development

You mentioned Accounting & Notary consulting as a side hustle. As this income grows, additional strategies become available:

- **Current LLC Structure:** Single-Member LLC taxed as sole prop is appropriate for early-stage
- **Future Consideration:** If net SE income exceeds ~\$40K annually, evaluate S-Corporation election with your CPA (potential FICA tax savings)
- **Promotion Impact:** When your W-2 income increases (you mentioned potential 2x), revisit tax brackets and strategy optimization

Section 6: Illustrative Portfolio Scenario

Educational Investment Scenario (Based on Profile Analysis)

Based on your indicated moderately aggressive risk tolerance and growth-focused goals, the following scenario models one approach to investment allocation. This is for educational illustration only and does not constitute investment advice.

Asset Class	Scenario %	Conservative (\$7,500)	Aggressive (\$75,000)	Educational Rationale
Bitcoin	60%	\$4,500	\$45,000	Growth-focused allocation; fixed 21M supply creates scarcity; increasing institutional adoption
STRC	25%	\$1,875	\$18,750	Bitcoin-correlated passive income (10-12% historical yield); aligns with passive income goals
VTI/VOO	15%	\$1,125	\$11,250	Broad U.S. market exposure at low cost (0.03% expense ratio); lower volatility anchor

Asset Education

Bitcoin: Bitcoin serves as a wealth accumulation vehicle due to its fixed 21 million supply and increasing institutional adoption. As a highly volatile asset, it carries significant risk including potential loss of principal.

STRC: STRC is commonly used by investors seeking passive income with Bitcoin correlation, providing approximately 10-12% annual yield. Verify current yield at time of investment—historical yields are not guaranteed.

VTI (Vanguard Total Stock Market ETF): VTI provides broad U.S. equity exposure across large, mid, and small-cap stocks at a 0.03% expense ratio. Commonly used for core equity diversification.

VOO (Vanguard S&P 500 ETF): VOO tracks the S&P 500 index, offering exposure to 500 of the largest U.S. companies. Also available at 0.03% expense ratio.

This scenario models one approach based on the moderately aggressive profile and growth-focused goals indicated. Specific investment decisions should be made in consultation with a licensed financial advisor who understands your complete situation. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal.

Important Context: Given your current IRS tax liability and credit rehabilitation priority, discuss with your financial advisor whether immediate investment deployment or accelerated debt payoff produces the better outcome for your situation. Cash reserves for emergencies (3-6 months expenses) should also be considered.

Section 7: Modeled First-Year Value Summary (2026 Tax Year)

This comprehensive summary models the potential first-year value across all strategy categories. Conservative scenario uses \$7,500 investment capital; Aggressive scenario uses \$75,000.

Category	Item	Conservative	Aggressive	Notes
CATEGORY A: TAX OPTIMIZATION				
Tax	Solo 401(k) Tax Savings	\$1,350	\$2,250	\$4,500-\$7,500 contribution × 30%
Tax	Backdoor Roth (positioning)	—	\$2,580	\$8,600 positioned for tax-free growth
Tax	Augusta Rule	\$1,050	\$2,520	7-12 days × \$500-\$700 × 30%
Tax	Home Office	\$150	\$300	100-200 sq ft × \$5 × 30%
Tax	Vehicle (72.5¢/mile)	\$435	\$1,088	2,000-5,000 miles × \$0.725 × 30%
Tax	STR + Cost Segregation	\$0	\$0	RE deferred (credit rehabilitation)
Tax Optimization Subtotal		\$2,985	\$8,738	
CATEGORY B: INVESTMENT INCOME (Yield/Dividends)				
Income	STRC Yield (10-12%)	\$188	\$2,250	\$1,875 × 10% / \$18,750 × 12%
Income	ETF Dividends (1.5-2%)	\$17	\$225	\$1,125 × 1.5% / \$11,250 × 2%
Investment Income Subtotal		\$205	\$2,475	
CATEGORY C: INVESTMENT APPRECIATION (Projected Growth)				
Growth	Bitcoin (25-50%)	\$1,125	\$22,500	\$4,500 × 25% / \$45,000 × 50%
Growth	STRC (15-30%)	\$281	\$5,625	\$1,875 × 15% / \$18,750 × 30%
Growth	VTI/VOO (8-12%)	\$90	\$1,350	\$1,125 × 8% / \$11,250 × 12%

Category	Item	Conservative	Aggressive	Notes
Appreciation Subtotal		\$1,496	\$29,475	
CATEGORY D: REAL ESTATE				
RE	STR Annual Cash Flow (NOI)	\$0	\$0	Deferred: credit rehabilitation focus
RE	Property Appreciation	\$0	\$0	Phase 2 after credit rebuild
RE	Mortgage Principal Paydown	\$0	\$0	Phase 2 after credit rebuild
Real Estate Subtotal		\$0	\$0	RE interest noted; deferred to Phase 2
CATEGORY E: CASH FLOW IMPROVEMENTS				
Cash Flow	W-4 Optimization	\$1,200	\$3,000	\$100-\$250/month × 12
Cash Flow	Debt Interest Savings	—	—	Focus on IRS liability first
Cash Flow Subtotal		\$1,200	\$3,000	
CATEGORY F: WEALTH BUILDING (Dollars Positioned)				
Wealth	Solo 401(k) Contributions	\$4,500	\$7,500	Limited by ~\$20K net SE income
Wealth	Backdoor Roth IRA	\$8,600	\$8,600	\$7,500 + \$1,100 catch-up (2026)
Wealth	Augusta Rule Income Received	\$3,500	\$8,400	Tax-free rental income (14-day rule)
Wealth	RE Equity Position	\$0	\$0	Phase 2 strategy
Wealth Building Subtotal		\$16,600	\$24,500	
TOTAL FIRST-YEAR VALUE (2026)		\$22,486	\$68,188	

Value Summary Verification

Category	Conservative	Aggressive
Tax Optimization Subtotal	\$2,985	\$8,738
Investment Income Subtotal	\$205	\$2,475
Appreciation Subtotal	\$1,496	\$29,475
Real Estate Subtotal	\$0	\$0
Cash Flow Subtotal	\$1,200	\$3,000
Wealth Building Subtotal	\$16,600	\$24,500
GRAND TOTAL	\$22,486	\$68,188

Projected values are illustrative estimates for the 2026 tax year based on assumptions stated. Investment appreciation is based on historical performance and is not guaranteed—past performance does not guarantee future results. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency are highly volatile. Tax savings shown use 2026 IRS limits; verify with your CPA. Consult with your licensed professionals before implementation.

Section 8: Calendar Awareness & Key Dates (2026)

The following dates are provided for awareness. Verify all deadlines with your tax professional.

Date	Item	Notes
February 2026	CPA consultation: 2025 tax filing preparation	Address IRS liability, verify 2025 opportunities
April 15, 2026	2025 IRA/HSA contribution deadline	Last day for prior-year contributions
April 15, 2026	2025 tax filing deadline	Or file extension (still pay estimated taxes)
Q2-Q3 2026	Credit rehabilitation milestones	Target 620+ for expanded financing options
September 2026	Preliminary 2026 tax planning review	Verify strategy implementation status
October-November 2026	Open enrollment period	Evaluate HDHP options for HSA eligibility
December 31, 2026	Solo 401(k) establishment deadline	Required for 2026 employee deferrals
December 31, 2026	401(k) employee contribution deadline	Last day for 2026 deferrals
April 15, 2027	2026 IRA/HSA contribution deadline	Final opportunity for 2026 contributions

Quarterly Check-In Framework

- **Q1 (Jan-Mar):** File 2025 taxes, make 2025 IRA contribution, set up tracking systems
- **Q2 (Apr-Jun):** Establish Solo 401(k), review W-4 adjustment impact, credit score check
- **Q3 (Jul-Sep):** Mid-year tax planning review, Augusta Rule event planning, credit rehabilitation progress
- **Q4 (Oct-Dec):** Max out 2026 contributions, finalize Augusta Rule documentation, year-end planning

Section 9: Questions for Your Professional Team

The following questions are provided to help guide discussions with your licensed professionals. They do not constitute recommendations or action items.

FOR YOUR CPA

"Based on my income, age (60), and self-employment situation, what are my maximum 2026 retirement contributions? How do I calculate the Solo 401(k) limit given my estimated \$20K net SE income?"

FOR YOUR CPA

"Given the IRS liability situation, what payment plan options make the most sense? How does this affect my optimal tax strategy for 2026?"

FOR YOUR CPA

"Can I still make a 2025 IRA contribution before April 15? What type (Traditional or Roth) makes most sense given my current tax situation?"

FOR YOUR CPA

"What documentation do I need to maintain for the Augusta Rule rental, home office deduction, and vehicle mileage? How should I establish fair market value for my home?"

FOR YOUR CPA

"When my W-2 income increases with the promotion, how should we adjust my tax strategy? Should we revisit S-Corporation election for the LLC?"

FOR FINANCIAL ADVISOR

"Given my goal of rebuilding retirement after the scam situation, how does this investment scenario align with my timeline and risk tolerance?"

FOR FINANCIAL ADVISOR

"Should I prioritize paying down the IRS liability or investing the aggressive scenario capital? What's the break-even analysis?"

FOR CREDIT COUNSELOR/CPA

"What's the fastest path from 584 to 680+ credit score? Are there specific actions that would accelerate this timeline?"

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Section 10: Professional Team Considerations

Implementation of the strategies discussed in this educational document typically involves consultation with the following professionals:

Professional	Role	Your Status
CPA / Tax Professional	Tax strategy verification, IRS liability resolution, retirement contribution calculations, entity structure guidance	☒ Currently have CPA
Licensed Financial Advisor	Investment allocation guidance, retirement planning, risk assessment, portfolio implementation	Consider consulting for investment decisions
Attorney (if needed)	Entity structuring, asset protection, contract review for consulting business	May need for LLC operating agreement review
Insurance Professional	HDHP evaluation for HSA eligibility, business liability coverage for consulting	Consider during open enrollment

Section 11: Educational Milestone Framework

The following milestones are provided as a framework for tracking progress. Actual timelines depend on individual circumstances.

Timeframe	Educational Milestone	Considerations
30 Days	Foundation established	CPA consultation completed, tracking systems in place, 2025 IRA decision made
90 Days	Tax optimization active	W-4 adjusted, Solo 401(k) research completed, mileage tracking operational
6 Months	Credit rehabilitation progress	Credit score improving toward 620+ target, IRS payment plan established
12 Months	2026 strategies implemented	Solo 401(k) established, retirement contributions on track, Augusta Rule documented

18 Months	Phase 2 readiness	Credit score 680+, real estate financing options expanded, evaluate STR/cost segregation strategies
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Phase 2 Preview: Once credit rehabilitation is complete (target 680+), a Phase 2 Wealth Strategy Snapshot could incorporate real estate strategies including STR acquisition and cost segregation. This could add modeled value of \$40,000-\$64,000 in the aggressive scenario based on typical STR + cost segregation benefits.

Section 12: Educational Resources & 2026 Reference

2026 Contribution Limits Reference

Account Type	Base Limit	Catch-Up (50+)	Super Catch-Up (60-63)	Your Maximum
401(k) Employee Deferral	\$24,500	+\$8,000	+\$11,250	\$35,750
401(k) Total (Employee + Employer)	\$72,000	+\$8,000	+\$11,250	\$83,250
HSA (Individual Coverage)	\$4,400	+\$1,000 (55+)		\$5,400
HSA (Family Coverage)	\$8,750	+\$1,000 (55+)		\$9,750
Traditional/Roth IRA	\$7,500	+\$1,100		\$8,600

Business Mileage Rate for 2026: 72.5¢ per mile

IRS Resources (Educational Reference)

- **IRS.gov/Solo401k:** Solo 401(k) plan information
- **IRS.gov/HSA:** Health Savings Account guidance
- **IRS.gov/HomeOffice:** Home office deduction information
- **Publication 463:** Travel, Gift, and Car Expenses
- **Publication 587:** Business Use of Your Home

SECURE 2.0 Act Reminder

Super Catch-Up (Ages 60-63): Starting in 2025, individuals aged 60-63 can contribute an additional \$11,250 (indexed for inflation) to 401(k) plans instead of the standard \$8,000 catch-up. This higher limit applies to you for 2026.

Roth Catch-Up Requirement: Beginning in 2026, if you earned \$150,000+ in FICA wages in the prior year from the same employer, catch-up contributions must be made as Roth (not pre-tax). This likely does not apply to you given current income levels, but may apply after your promotion.

For educational reference only. Verify all limits and rules with IRS.gov or your tax professional.

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Important Disclaimers

Educational Purpose: This Wealth Strategy Snapshot is provided for educational and illustrative purposes only. It does not constitute individualized investment, tax, or legal advice.

Not Investment Advice: Legacy Investing Show and its staff are not registered investment advisers. This document does not recommend the purchase, sale, or holding of any security. Investment scenarios presented are illustrative models for educational purposes only. All investments carry risk including potential loss of principal.

Not Tax Advice: Tax strategies discussed are educational explanations of how certain provisions work. Eligibility, implementation, and actual tax outcomes depend on your specific circumstances and must be verified by a qualified CPA or tax attorney before implementation.

Not Legal Advice: Entity structure, asset protection, and partnership discussions are educational. Consult a qualified attorney for legal guidance specific to your situation.

No Guarantees: Projected values, potential savings, and scenario outcomes are illustrative estimates based on assumptions stated. Actual results will vary based on market conditions, tax law changes, and individual circumstances. Past performance does not guarantee future results.

Investment Risk Disclosure: All investments involve risk. Bitcoin and cryptocurrency investments are highly volatile and speculative. Real estate investments carry risks including market fluctuations, vacancy, and unexpected expenses. You could lose some or all of your invested capital.

Tax Law Changes: Tax laws change regularly. Information presented reflects understanding as of February 2026 using 2026 IRS limits. Verify current rules with your tax professional.

Professional Consultation Required: Before implementing any strategy discussed in this document, consult with qualified licensed professionals including a CPA, attorney, and/or registered investment adviser who understand your complete financial situation.

Limitation of Liability: Legacy Investing Show assumes no liability for actions taken based on information in this educational document. You are solely responsible for your financial decisions.

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